

DeckForge Viability Analysis

Which onboarding feature can our card data actually support?

New players are overwhelmed and leaving

A new player opens the app and sees hundreds of cards with no sense of what goes with what.

They don't know where to start, so most of them don't come back.

WHERE IT HURTS MOST

The first week after signup

WHAT MANAGEMENT WANTS

One onboarding feature, next quarter

Find a way to make the card pool make sense

We were asked to check the data first, then recommend one solution out of the 3 proposed ideas.

1

**Look at what the data
actually contains**

2

**Rule out ideas the data
can't support**

3

**Build the one idea that
works**

Three ideas were on the table

A

Archetype Browser

Group cards by how they actually play — walls, attackers, engine cards, support.

B

Price Tracker

Flag cards that are likely to rise in value, for the collector crowd.

C

Power-Level Warning

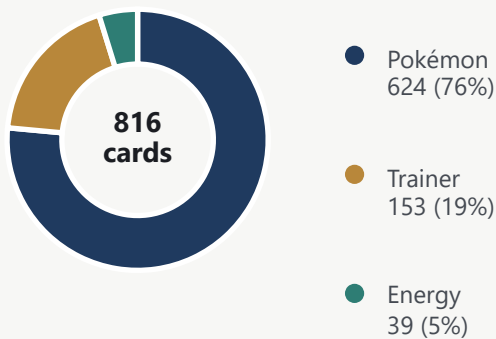
Flag cards that are over- or under-costed for what they do.

What we're working with

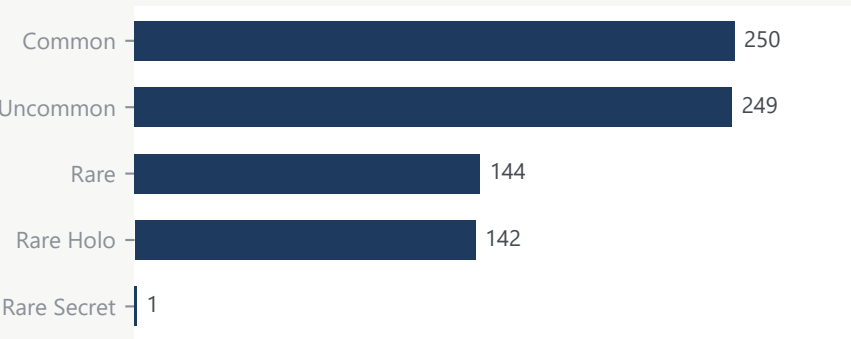
DATA QUALITY CHECK

- 816 cards total — no duplicates or broken rows
- Blank fields are not errors (e.g. Trainer and Energy cards have no HP or attacks by the rules of the game)
- Free retreat shows up as blank instead of "0"

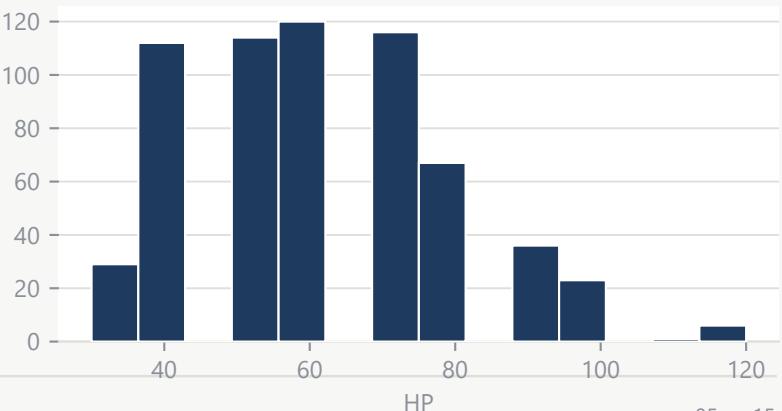
CARD TYPES



CARD RARITY



HP SPREAD



Two ideas don't survive contact with the data

A · Archetype Browser



Viable

We have every card's stats, attack details, and ability text to group by.

B · Price Tracker



Not viable

No price data exists in the dataset. Value depends on age, scarcity and hype.

C · Power-Level Warning



Not viable

A card's real strength depends on the deck it's played in, not just its own stats.

Turning raw card text into something we can group

Card mechanics were condensed into text blocks. We pulled them out in two steps.

1

Pull out the numbers

- Number of attacks
- Damage dealt
- Energy cost
- Damage per energy spent
- Retreat cost

2

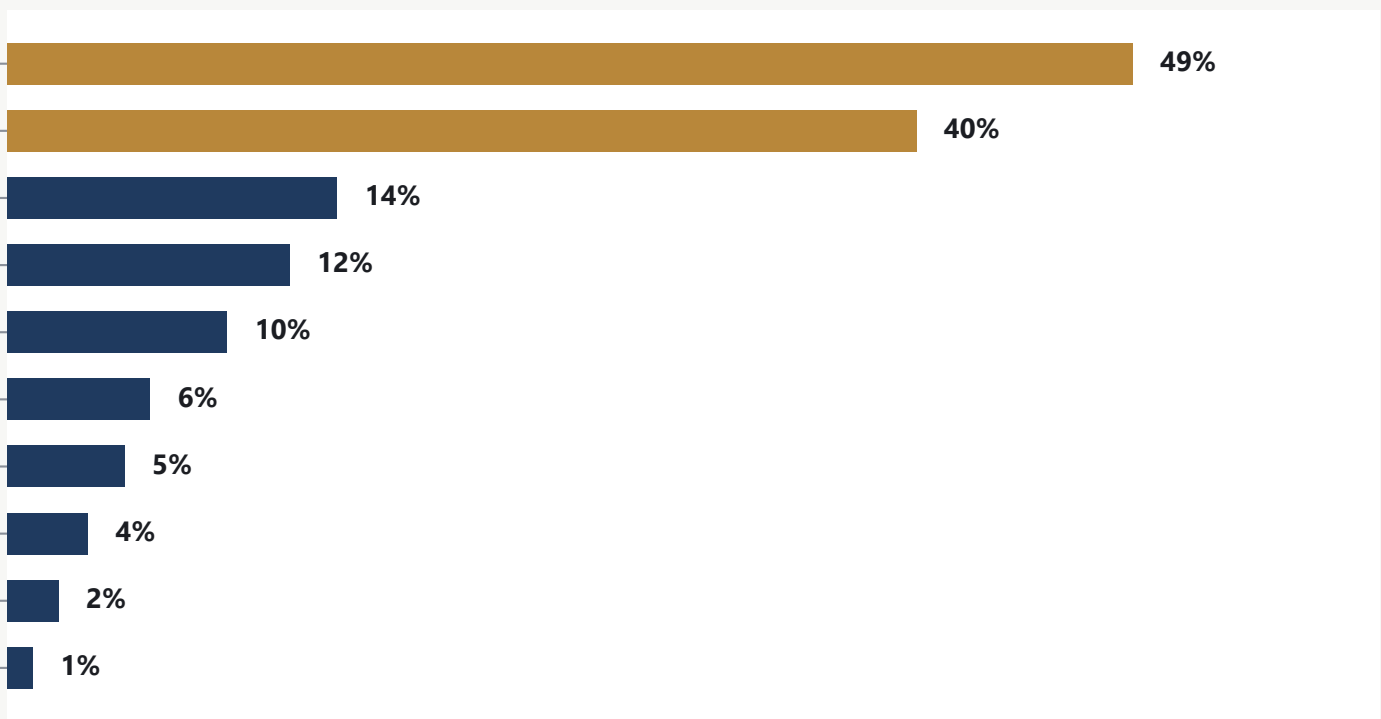
Read what the card does

We scanned attack and ability text for 10 recurring effects, e.g.:

draw**heal****status****accel****coins****discards****switch****prevent****counter****search**

What Pokémon cards actually do

Share of Pokémon cards carrying each effect, from the classic Base Set – Neo Genesis era.



WORTH NOTING

Coin flips — 49%

Classic Base-Set-era cards lean heavily on coin-flip luck.

Status effects — 40%

Paralyze, confuse, poison and sleep show up constantly.

Energy boosts — 1%

Rare, but the cards that have it are strategically important.

Letting the data form its own groups

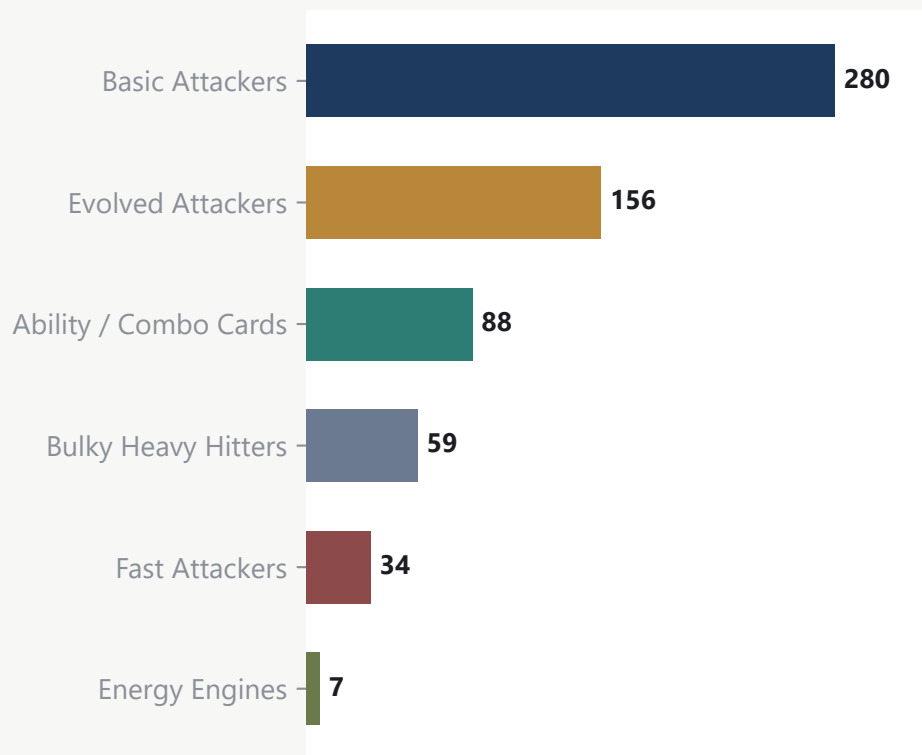
Rather than guessing categories up front, similar cards were grouped together automatically, based on the profile each card now had.



Trainer and Energy cards don't have attacks or abilities, so they're sorted separately by their own role.

Six archetypes, ready to name in the app

GROUP SIZES



● Basic Attackers

Simple, low-HP, unevolved — the entry-level pool.

● Evolved Attackers

Reliable mid-game damage, no ability needed.

● Ability / Combo Cards

Every card here has a special ability.

● Bulky Heavy Hitters

High HP, hits hardest, slow to retreat.

● Fast Attackers

Cheap to retreat and easy to cycle in and out.

● Energy Engines

Rare, but powers up the whole team faster.

Example cards in each group

Do the cards inside each group actually belong together?

Basic Attackers

Clefairy, Hitmonchan, Mewtwo,
Electabuzz

Bulky Heavy Hitters

Chansey, Charizard, Nidoking,
Poliwrath

Ability / Combo Cards

Alakazam, Machop, Venusaur,
Electrode

Evolved Attackers

Gyarados, Magneton, Raichu,
Dragonair

Fast Attackers

Ninetales, Pidgeotto, Pidgey,
Viktreebel

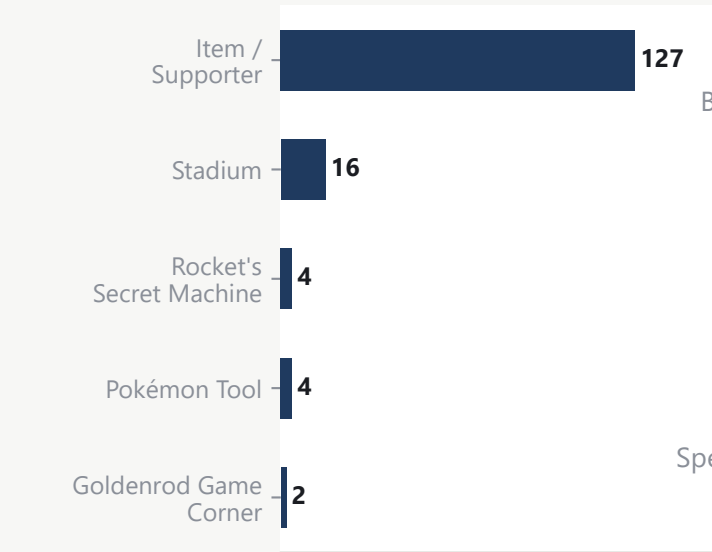
Energy Engines

Blastoise, Dark Magneton,
Misty's Tentacool, Blaine's
Ninetales

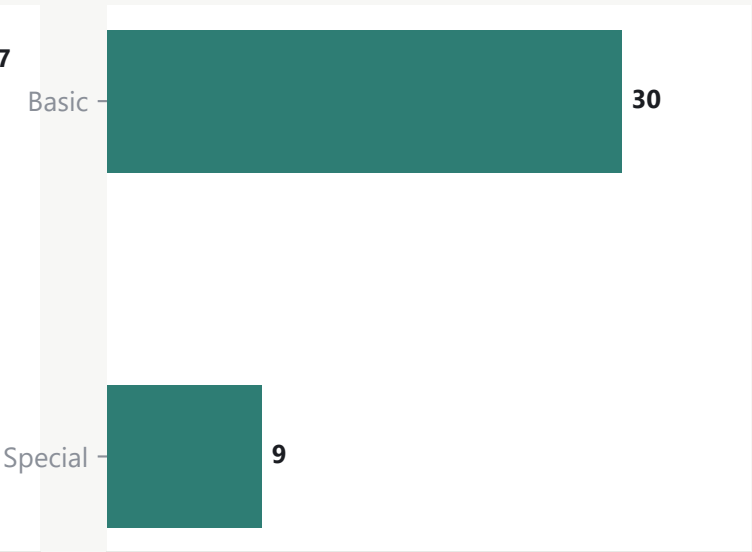
Trainer and Energy cards, sorted by role

These 192 cards don't attack, so they can't go through the same grouping .
Instead they're sorted by the role already built into the card.

TRAINER — 153 TOTAL



ENERGY — 39 TOTAL



IN THE APP

This would act as a separate tab from the pokemon grouping

How sure are we about these groups?

Groups blend at the edges

A card can be a bit “attacker” and a bit “wall” at the same time. That’s just how these cards are designed.

We checked it by hand

We pulled real example cards from every group and confirmed they matched the group’s description before naming anything.

Bottom line: not perfectly clean-cut, but consistent enough to label and ship.

Ship the Archetype Browser

Use the 6 Pokémon groups, plus a separate tab for Trainer and Energy cards.

- Label the browse experience with these groups
- Seed starter collections for new players (e.g. a “Fast Attackers” starter deck)
- Revisit the groups whenever new card sets are added



Questions?

Thanks for the time — happy to walk through any of the groups in more detail.